

Housing crisis in the Netherlands

This news article was written by Hoger Onderwijs Persbureau and published on 4th September 2026 in the Independent news platform of Erasmus University.

Why are we interested in this topic?

We are interested in this topic because it is becoming increasingly difficult to find housing in our own city. On top of that prices for housing are increasing and there is no end in sight since it is one of the societal challenges that affects us directly and we can feel immediate changes in policies or laws or even investments made by the government. Therefore we think that there is very few societal challenges that are more important to us as students living abroad.

For whom is this challenge relevant?

It's relevant to all whom are about to look for housing in the Netherlands not only students but everyone since the shortage also affects other people that rent a home. Although we need to highlight the role students play here since students mostly have to move more often because they are not settled in life yet. Especially when it comes to the amount of international students that come from a different country sometimes they are not even able to look at rooms before they get to the Netherlands. Also they don't know the current situation of the housing market very well and have to rely on housing agencies and landlords that are not always making fair prices for their home to rent.

Scientific articles

The housing market in The Netherlands as a driver for social inequalities: proposals for reform

ORIGINAL ARTICLE:

Boelhouwer, P. (2020). *The housing market in The Netherlands as a driver for social inequalities: proposals for reform*. *International Journal of Housing Policy*, 20(3), 447–456. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19491247.2019.1663056>

This paper reveals dysfunctions of Dutch housing market. It states that current market emphasises social inequalities and tries to propose reforms to that issue. It highlights drop in housing production since 2013 and government changes as base of existing problems. Additionally, author explains issues of middle-income

Still a shortage of 20,000 student homes



Hoger Onderwijs Persbureau

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Housing

Thousands of new student homes have been built, yet the room shortage has barely decreased. New figures show that 20,000 students are unsuccessfully looking for accommodation.



Students talking outside of student housing in Kratingen.

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Since 2022, student housing providers have built nearly 5,000 new student homes a year, writes Kences, the knowledge centre for student housing. Yet the housing shortage among students has barely decreased.

Nationally, there is a shortage of 20,200 homes for students who want to leave home, according to the National Student Housing Monitor, which was [published](#) on Wednesday evening. The shortage has decreased by just 1,300 since last year.

Shortage no worse

But that is also the good news: at least the housing shortage among students has not worsened. Last year, Kences expected the shortage to increase sharply, as many private landlords began selling their student homes. New tax rules had made the properties less profitable.

Many homes have indeed been sold: since 2024, 32,000 fewer students have rented accommodation from private landlords, ranging from rogue landlords to resident landlords. But this has not led to an explosive increase in the housing shortage.

There are also fewer Dutch students, while fewer international students are coming here. In addition, fewer and fewer Dutch students live away from home. Over eight years, the proportion has fallen from 50 to 43 per cent.

Estimate

The shortage is an estimate: it concerns the number of students who want to live away from home but have no accommodation available to them. But how many students want to leave home? That is not so easy to determine.

"Supply also creates demand", says Kences director Reijnder Jan Spits. "With new-build projects, we see that students who had given up hope start actively looking again." In other words, when new student homes are built, some house-hunters who had dropped out begin to think they have a chance again, and are then counted in the shortage once more.

There are other factors that may affect demand. The basic grant has been reintroduced and housing benefit for young people has been expanded, so students may have more money to spend: that could affect demand, Spits says.

On the other hand, life is already expensive and, Spits speculates, first-year students may now be more concerned about the binding study recommendation and wait a while before leaving home.

Space

Continuing to build is important in any case, he believes. Student housing providers might be given more opportunities to build on campus, so that they do not compete with other demands on space, he suggests.

Student housing providers must have sufficient financial resources to build, he says. Kences therefore argues for abolishing profit tax for these housing associations. It would make a difference of 15,000 to 20,000 homes, he estimates.

But if the business case for new housing is positive, surely housing associations can find financing? According to Spits, it is not that simple. You cannot simply borrow money, he says. "The regulators have views on that."

By city

The housing shortage is not equally severe everywhere, but in many cities the situation is difficult. Kences: "Pressure on the student housing market is highest in Amsterdam, Delft, Eindhoven, Leiden, Nijmegen, Rotterdam, 's-Hertogenbosch, Utrecht and Zwolle." The fewest problems are found in Tilburg, Wageningen, Arnhem, Leeuwarden and Ede.

Students are taking increasingly longer to find a home: students at universities of applied sciences and universities who live away from home took five months on average. This excludes students who never find accommodation. In the 2017/18 academic year, the search time was 3.5 months.

Yet a lack of homes is the reason for still living at home for only 19 per cent of students. 44 per cent cite the affordability of homes as their reason for still living at home. Only 21 per cent simply have no desire to leave home, while 11 per cent say: my parents live near my place of study.

For a room with shared facilities, students pay an average of 540 euros a month, Kences states on the basis of a survey completed by 42,000 students at 41 universities of applied sciences and universities. Multi-room homes cost 855 euros on average, although someone else often contributes to the payment. On average, accommodation costs 590 euros a month, out of a student's disposable budget of 1,340 euros.

More expensive

Some cities are more expensive than others, according to the same survey. In Amsterdam, The Hague and Rotterdam, the price of a room with shared facilities is said to be around 650 euros a month. Multi-room homes average around 950 euros.

Kamernet, the largest platform for private rooms, [estimates](#) the average room rent in Amsterdam to be 300 euros higher, but does not distinguish between a single room and a flat. Nationally, the average rent would be 691 euros according to Kamernet.

earners that are locked out of both purchasing and private renting. What's more, this paper states that tax deductions are affecting both existing homeowners as well as young starters and renters. This article states all problems that current housing market faces and past changes that lead to that, while proposing reforms to improve life of dutch citizens and expats.

Housing trajectories of EU migrants: between quick emigration and shared housing as temporary and long-term solutions.

ORIGINAL ARTICLE:

Manting, D., Kleinepiper, T., & Lennartz, C. (2024). *Housing trajectories of EU migrants: between quick emigration and shared housing as temporary and long-term solutions*. *Housing Studies*, 39(4), 1027–1048. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2022.2101629>

Manting, Kleinepiper and Lennartz show how migration from other countries in the European Union to the Netherlands is influenced by the housing crisis and prices. More and more migrants choose shared accommodation, caused by high prices and unavailability of housing. The authors warn about potential dangers resulting in the crisis such as worse integration, social cohesion and overall appeal of immigration to the Netherlands. This article reveals actual data and consequences and the studies mentioned are done on citizens from countries that are both workers and students in the Netherlands.

Navigating the Field of Housing: Housing Pathways of Young People in Amsterdam

ORIGINAL ARTICLE:

Hochstenbach, Cody, and Willem R. Boterman. "Navigating the Field of Housing: Housing Pathways of Young People in Amsterdam." *Journal of Housing and the Built Environment*, vol. 30, no. 2, 2015, pp. 257–74. JSTOR, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/43907327>. Accessed 4 Sept. 2026.

This article is about housing in the Netherlands and especially in Amsterdam. The article is relevant because it highlights that statistics are not everythign because a lot of people are not even allowed or able to register in the Netherlands, also it shows that getting a home is not only about price but also about luck/ waitinglists. Landlords breaking rules subventing and other things have become normality this is also important for a data based research since there is gonna be a lot of falsified data.

'We prefer our Dutch': International Students

ORIGINAL ARTICLE:

Fang, Christian, and Ilse van Liempt. "'We prefer our Dutch': International Students' Housing Experiences in the Netherlands." *Housing Studies*, vol. 36, no. 6, 2021, pp. 822–842. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2020.1720618>. Accessed 4 Sept. 2026.

Subtype: original research article (empirical, qualitative). The authors collected their own data, 18 semi-structured interviews with international students in Utrecht, analysed with Qualitative Content Analysis. It is not a review or an opinion paper.

Our challenge is the struggle of international students on the Dutch housing market. This article is exactly that topic, and it is one of the few studies that asks the students themselves instead of only looking at numbers.

Fang and van Liempt interviewed international students in Utrecht about how they find and keep housing. They found four different pathways, from students who improve their situation to students who end up outside the formal housing sector completely, so internationals are not equally disadvantaged and the difference comes mostly from money and timing. Much of the market is simply closed to them: adverts openly say "NO INTERNATIONALS" or "Dutch-speaking only", which is illegal but common, and one interviewee estimated up to 40 per cent of listings. Search effort barely mattered, since students used nearly the same strategies but got very different results. Many ended up in illegal rooms where they could not register, which means no BSN, no bank account, no health insurance and no residence permit for non-EU students, so the

worst-off students are also missing or wrongly recorded in official data. This article is relevant because it gives our challenge the students' own perspective and shows the mechanisms behind the numbers.